



Melbourne Archdiocese
Catholic Schools

2023

Annual Report to the School Community



Good Shepherd School

30 Academy Avenue, WHEELERS HILL 3150

Principal: Jacqueline Marshall

Web: www.goodshep.vic.edu.au

Registration: 1682, E Number: E1271

Principal's Attestation

I, Jacqueline Marshall, attest that Good Shepherd School is compliant with:

- The minimum standards and other requirements for school registration and school boarding premises (if applicable) as specified in the Education and Training Reform Act 2006 (Vic) and the Education and Training Reform Regulations 2017 (Vic).
- Australian Government accountability requirements related to the 2023 school year under the Australian Education Act 2013 (Cth) and the Australian Education Regulations 2023 (Cth).
- The Child Safe Standards as prescribed in Ministerial Order 1359 – Implementing the Child Safe Standards, Managing the Risk of Child Abuse in Schools and School Boarding Premises.

Attested on 14 Jun 2024

About this report

Good Shepherd School is registered by the Victorian Registration and Qualifications Authority (VRQA). The Annual Report to the School Community (ARSC), provides parents and the wider community with information about the school's activities and achievements throughout the year including information about various aspects of school performance. The Report is supplementary to other forms of regular communication to the school community regarding initiatives, activities and programs which support the learning and wellbeing of its students. Further information about the contents of this Report may be obtained by contacting the School directly or by visiting the School's website. Information can also be obtained from the [My School website](#).

Governing Authority Report

When Melbourne Archdiocese Catholic Schools (MACS) launched our inaugural strategic plan MACS 2030: Forming Lives to Enrich the World just over a year ago, I spoke about the need for our whole organisation to reflect on the biggest challenges that confront us, and to work at speed to find practical, ambitious, student-centred solutions.

As a relatively new governing authority, 2023 set us on the path to achieving our first goals, as we focussed our efforts on building strong foundations for success. The four pillars of MACS2030 – Inspired by Faith; Flourishing Learners; Enabled Leaders; and Enriched Communities - serve to guide our work on how we achieve our strategic intent.

When we surveyed our teachers in late 2022, over 80 per cent told us that they want access to quality teaching and assessment resources. So in January 2023, we secured a system-wide licence for MACS primary and secondary schools to access the Progressive Achievement Test (PAT) assessment suite. The inclusion of the Social and Emotional Wellbeing Survey allows schools to monitor the wellbeing of their students and target resourcing to specific areas of need. Together, these tools provide a coherent and systematic approach to student assessment.

In partnership with Ochre Education, we began work on F-6 Mathematics curriculum resources, being developed in a phased approach over three years, and delivered the first tranche for F-2. A key consideration in developing the materials is ensuring teachers retain autonomy to tailor curriculum implementation to meet the individual and local needs of students.

This is an exciting development for our MACS community, clearly demonstrating the commitment we all share to delivering the best possible education opportunities for our 120,000 students and supporting our 10,000 classroom teachers to be the very best that they can be.

Archbishop Peter commissioned a comprehensive review of Religious Education curriculum, the first in over a decade. It offers us some challenges, but fundamentally is a hope-filled report that invites a path of ongoing work to develop a new RE curriculum for all Catholic schools. We continued Working Together in Mission with Parish Priests throughout the Archdiocese, including through regular roundtable discussions.

Across greater Melbourne, one in five students attend a Catholic school and 2023 saw steady growth in enrolments across our system, demonstrating the value families place on a Catholic education and the high quality, holistic education MACS schools provide.

As a system of schools, we can be better together, reducing the administrative load on our schools and freeing our teachers and principals to focus on what they do best.

I would like to pay tribute to our MACS school and office colleagues who have worked so hard to achieve our goals. We look forward to further strengthening those partnerships as we work together to deliver an education that inspires young people to enrich the world.

Yours sincerely

Dr Edward Simons

Executive Director

Melbourne Archdiocese Catholic Schools Ltd

Vision and Mission

We are committed to providing each child with the opportunity to reach their full potential spiritually, intellectually, physically, emotionally and socially. We aim to develop the whole child.

Our vision is that:

- By the time our children leave us, they will have a strong sense of belonging to the Catholic Community.
- The school community is immersed in, and engaged in, an environment of lived faith, where Christian values are seen as the guiding principles.
- The parents of our children are given the opportunity to develop their faith. Caring and supportive relationships are developed and are an integral part of the child's growth and development.
- Our children are educated in an environment which fosters a love of learning, allows each child to experience success and builds a positive self image.

Our School Values:

Respect Care and Acceptance Responsibility Doing our Best Honesty

School Overview

Good Shepherd School Wheelers Hill is part of the parish of Good Shepherd, Mulgrave. It is situated approximately 26km south-east of Melbourne. The school was established in 1970.

The community is truly a multi-cultural one with numerous nationalities being represented.

Approximately seventy percent of students come from families where parents were either born overseas or they are the first generation children of immigrant parents. The vast majority of children completing their education at Good Shepherd School continue their studies at Catholic Secondary Schools, predominantly at Avila College and Sacred Heart College for girls and Mazenod College for boys.

In 2023, Approximately 500 students were enrolled at Good Shepherd School. The school is situated on eight acres of land. There are ample playing areas with a large grassed oval with running track, adventure playground equipment and a quadrangle with a netball court and a basketball court. Three tennis courts are adjacent to the Performing Arts' Building.

In 2023, the school was organised into twenty-one classes. 3 x Foundation, 3 x Year 1, 3 x Year 2, 3 x Year 3, 3 x Year 4, 3 x Year 5, 3 x Year 6.

Specialist classes include Music, Physical Education, L.O.T.E. (Mandarin), STEM and Library.

Principal's Report

At Good Shepherd we endeavour to provide our students with a well-balanced and engaging curriculum that will enable them to achieve their full potential. We trust that the environment we have created enables them to be confident and motivated learners. In recent years, Good Shepherd's Music Program has gone from strength to strength. The benefits of music for children are widely advertised by music practitioners. Meet our music staff, and you will recognise that they have a passion for teaching music and value the joy the program brings to the community:

It assists in improving brain power, memory and concentration,

It teaches discipline and patience,

It inspires creativity and builds confidence.

Ruth Jones retired as Principal at Good Shepherd after twenty-eight years of service.

We would like to take this opportunity to thank Ruth for her service to the community of Good Shepherd over this time. As a servant leader Ruth always found strength in her faith and this included her active involvement in parish life. As an educator at Good Shepherd for many years Ruth developed strong connections and will be remembered by many.

In 2024 we welcome Jacqueline Marshall as the new Principal at Good Shepherd.

Catholic Identity and Mission

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Goal:

To guide our diverse student community in their encounter with the Gospel message.

Intended Outcomes:

That students actions, attitudes and behaviours reflect an appreciation of Gospel values.

Achievements

Achievements:

Our Religious Education Program aligns with the Archdiocese of Melbourne's guidelines and incorporates 'The Catechesis of The Good Shepherd', fostering a comprehensive approach to Religious Education embedded in the Pedagogy of Encounter and the Religious Education Framework. Our aim is to nurture the holistic development of students, instilling a connection to the Catholic Community through Christian values that extend throughout our school environment.

The staff at Good Shepherd school have actively participated in Professional Development opportunities to enhance their expertise in the curriculum and deepen their own faith. Through professional learning opportunities they have gained the tools to strengthen prayer and Catholic Tradition into daily practices, enriching the educational experience.

At Good Shepherd, we have integrated Inquiry, Wellbeing, and Religion, enabling students to develop their faith learning across different subject areas and apply strategies and skills to real-world scenarios.

Good Shepherd has implemented The Resilience Project, equipping students with valuable habits to navigate future challenges with resilience. Through weekly lessons focused on Gratitude, Empathy, and Mindfulness (GEM), both teachers and students build essential coping strategies.

Our students benefit from learning in The Good Shepherd Parish Atrium, a dedicated space designed to deepen their understanding of religious life through hands-on engagement with church materials and replicas. The Atrium serves as a valuable learning environment, bringing the teachings of Jesus to life.

Regular communal celebrations, including Mass and school-based liturgies, foster a sense of unity within the school and extend connections to the wider Parish community, nurturing a strong sense of belonging and shared faith.

Every Friday, classes take turns leading Prayer of the Air, centered around the upcoming Gospel or Feast Day. Students co-construct the presentation together. This encourages in-depth exploration of religious themes and promotes sharing of knowledge throughout the school community.

Value Added

- Mini Vinnies
- Whole School Carols
- School Choir
- Harmony Day
- School Assemblies
- Reconciliation Week
- Catholic Education Week
- Liturgical Celebrations
- Start-Up Week
- Sacramental Programs
- Wellbeing Club
- Buddy Program
- Year 6 Charity Fete

Learning and Teaching

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Goal:

To sustain and enhance our collaborative learning culture.

Intended Outcomes:

That teachers are empowered to consistently implement agreed pedagogical practices.

Achievements

At Good Shepherd, we remain steadfast in fostering a dynamic culture of ongoing enhancement in our pedagogical practices and student engagement, placing paramount importance on the voices, agency, and safety of our students within our learning and teaching endeavours. Dedicated to fostering the holistic development of each child—spiritually, intellectually, physically, emotionally, and socially—we ensure that students are not only active participants but valued contributors to their own educational journey.

Our leadership team are being guided on instructional best practice through 'The MACS Vision of Instruction', which ensures a consistent approach to learning and teaching excellence by focusing on enhancing cognitive engagement, a crucial aspect of learning. Drawing from the Cognitive Load Theory and the robust evidence based on 'The Science of Learning', Good Shepherd's learning and teaching aim is to implement best practice instruction, curriculum design and planning (evidence-based, knowledge-rich, coherent, and sequenced) and assessment practice. We believe taking this path will further enhance the effectiveness of our teaching methods and have a beneficial influence on student outcomes.

Embedded within our culture is a profound sense of shared responsibility and accountability for student well-being and success. Teachers are collaborating to analyse student data, employing high-impact teaching strategies while prioritising clear learning intentions and success criteria. We vigilantly monitor student progress using digital data walls and case management approaches, ensuring that every student's voice is heard and valued. Our teachers attend two Professional Learning meetings a week, where they are provided with

opportunities to collaborate, engage in professional development workshops, share best practices, and refine their teaching strategies to better support student learning and growth.

Our collaborative approach to learning is extending to empower students to take ownership of their learning. By actively involving them in the planning process and implementing explicit teaching strategies,, we cultivate a sense of agency and empowerment. Students are encouraged to lead, reflect, and self-assess, fostering a safe and inclusive learning environment where diverse perspectives are celebrated.

At the heart of our educational philosophy lies the belief that every student can learn and thrive. By implementing an Intervention Framework, we have created a Response to Intervention (RTI) model that is built upon a foundation of data-driven decision-making. Through collaborative efforts among teachers, leaders, and learning support staff, we are developing tailored intervention plans that prioritise individual student needs and strengths. These plans are being implemented with fidelity, utilising evidence-based practices and intervention programs, such as ERIK (Enhancing Reading Intervention Knowledge), LLI (Levelled Literacy Intervention), and Little Learners Love Literacy, to support student growth and success. Through regular progress monitoring we are ensuring that interventions are responsive and adaptive, allowing us to make timely adjustments as needed. Additionally, our intervention framework emphasises a multi-tiered system of support, providing varying levels of intervention intensity based on student responsiveness.

Furthermore, we are continuing to extend educational support to our students by collaborating with occupational therapists, speech pathologists, psychologists, and other specialised professionals. These partnerships ensure that each student receives personalised, holistic support, addressing their unique needs and fostering academic, emotional, and social well-being.

Student Learning Outcomes

Student Learning Outcomes in NAPLAN

Our 2023 Naplan results showed an outstanding performance in all areas of English and Mathematics of students in Year 3 and Year 5.

- Our Year 3 data for Reading, Writing, Spelling, Grammar and Numeracy indicated that our school's average is 'Well above' all Australian students.

- Our Year 5 data for Writing, Spelling and Numeracy demonstrated that our school's average is 'Well above' all Australian students and our Reading and Grammar data showed that we were 'Above'.

When comparing our 2022 and 2023 NAPLAN data, our Year 3 and Year 5 school average have both significantly increased in Reading and Writing.

This trend aligns with our learning and teaching objectives, which have been focused on developing our students English language knowledge and skills by:

- increasing teacher confidence in administering reading comprehension assessments
- improving whole-school consistency and collaboration through a whole-school assessment schedule
- facilitating opportunities for teachers to enhance their pedagogical practices by implementing two Professional Learning meetings a week
- partaking in regular whole-school reading and writing moderations
- ensuring learning and teaching is targeted towards accurate student data by creating digital data walls from Foundation to Year 6

NAPLAN - Proportion of students meeting the proficient standards			
Domain	Year level	Mean Scale score	Proficient
Grammar & Punctuation	Year 3	471	87%
	Year 5	536	82%
Numeracy	Year 3	465	87%
	Year 5	533	86%
Reading	Year 3	462	87%
	Year 5	527	90%
Spelling	Year 3	462	89%
	Year 5	539	92%
Writing	Year 3	464	97%
	Year 5	544	96%

*A school's NAPLAN test must have a minimum of 11 participants and 80% participation rate. Data not reported for 2023 due to participation not meeting these criteria or no students were assessed. Participants include students who were assessed, including non-attempt, or those exempted from the test.

Student Wellbeing

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Goal:

To develop closer connections with families and local communities.

Intended outcome:

That we draw on the richness of our diverse school and local community to enhance student learning and wellbeing.

Achievements

Good Shepherd School views Student Wellbeing as fundamental to successful learning. Children who are happy, confident and able to establish meaningful relationships are better placed to achieve positive learning outcomes. Creating and maintaining a respectful and safe school environment is a priority for us. It is an essential characteristic of the school community as we focus on developing a curriculum which is engaging and inclusive of a diverse range of learners. Our Wellbeing programs consider the social-emotional knowledge, skills and attitudes essential to developing healthy identities, managing emotions, feeling and showing empathy for others, establishing and maintaining supportive relationships, and making responsible and caring decisions.

Students at Good Shepherd feel connected to their peers and teachers and have a strong sense of belonging to our school. We start the year by having 'Start Up' week where minimal testing occurs, so the teachers can take time to develop essential relationships with students as they transition into their new grade level. The students are supported in all areas of their learning journey and establishing respectful relationships ensures they can thrive. There is a shared understanding of school expectations and values which are displayed throughout the school. Our 'Student of the Week' raffle ticket system has encouraged students to demonstrate our school values: Respect; Doing our best; Care and acceptance; Honesty; and Responsibility.

'The Hub' is a supervised play area which is open to all students who require a safe space during recess and lunch breaks. They engage in a variety of activities in this calm, non-

threatening environment. 'The Hub' allows children to explore their likes and dislikes, their emotions and use developing social skills to establish friendships in a safe way.

To promote student empowerment, Good Shepherd offers the Year Six students opportunities to take on leadership roles in an area they are interested in. Along with School Captains, there are: Sports; Wellbeing; Social Justice; Music; ICT; Library; Publicity and Environmental Leaders. Students work with teachers to develop leadership skills and recognise the importance of listening to others and working together. The Year Six leaders run frequent lunchtime clubs and promote these to other students. These clubs help build confidence and connections across all levels.

The whole school participates in nationally recognised days of action and awareness including Harmony Day; NAIDOC Week; the National Day of Action Against Bullying and Violence; National Buddy Day; and the National Day for Daniel. These days have various days help Good Shepherd to promote child safety awareness.

Good Shepherd staff members have participated in regular professional learning and training sessions to ensure the school's legislative obligations related to the Child Safe Standards are addressed. This includes completion of the Online Mandatory Reporting Modules. Staff also participated in Wellbeing led PLTs with a focus on our whole school resource, The Resilience Project, and information about the importance of staff wellbeing.

Good Shepherd has implemented the use of The Resilience Project in all classrooms and this supports children to form habits that will increase their ability to deal with challenges, changes and stressors in the future. Through this program, teachers and students engage in weekly lessons and activities around the key principles of Gratitude, Empathy, Mindfulness and Emotional Literacy (GEM + EL) to build resilience. The overall aim is to embed GEM + EL principles in all aspects of school life including staff, parents and students.

All classes are involved in the Buddy Program. An older class is paired with a younger class and they participate in various activities. These sessions emphasise values including; caring for others, friendliness, respect, valuing difference, including others and responsibility.

At Good Shepherd, regular Parent Support Group (PSG) meetings are organised to ensure we are providing ongoing and effective support for our parents of students with special needs. Open communication between parents and teachers is encouraged through the use of Parent/Teacher Interviews, meetings and online platforms like SeeSaw and email. To support what is happening in the classroom, parents and carers receive information and activities in the newsletter, as well as other pieces of information regarding student wellbeing.

Value Added

'Start up' week

Student of the week raffle tickets

Explicitly taught Wellbeing lessons

Imbed 'GEM' principles throughout school life

'The Hub' Wellbeing Club

Lunchtime Clubs

Buddy Program

Harmony Day

National Day of Action Against Bullying & Violence

NADOIC Week

R U OK? Day

National Buddy Day

National Day for Daniel (Child Safety Day)

Updates featured in the newsletter

Charity Fete

Student Satisfaction

The 2023 MACSSIS data reports:

75% of students recognise the strength of the social connection between teachers and students, within and beyond the school.

73% of students feel they are valued members of our community.

75% of students sees themselves as learners.

Student Attendance

At Good Shepherd, we have high expectations for student attendance. Student attendance is consistently high across all year levels, demonstrating the students' desire to be at school to socialise and learn in a rich and nurturing school environment.

Unexplained absences are followed up with phone calls on the same day. In the rare instance of ongoing absence, school leaders reach to out to families to offer supports and guidance to work to restore school attendance.

Average Student Attendance Rate by Year Level	
Y01	92.6%
Y02	91.8%
Y03	92.4%
Y04	93.5%
Y05	92.8%
Y06	92.1%
Overall average attendance	92.5%

Leadership

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Priority:

Connect Catholic traditions to the life and the world of the students.

Goal:

To guide our diverse student community in their encounters with the Gospel message.

Intended outcome:

That students' actions, attitudes and behaviours reflect an appreciation of Gospel values.

Achievements

Good Shepherd School leadership focussed on developing a positive, supportive and collaborative organisational climate that enhances their capacity to foster continuous improvement.

This provides a good basis on which to build a culture of shared responsibility and accountability for all staff.

Staff are very supportive of each other and readily collaborate to work through challenges.

This is particularly evident in the observed planning meetings where leaders are integral in facilitating critical, professional dialogue about teacher practice and student learning.

Governance and management processes are based on a very clear imperative of maintaining

the strong catholicity of the school in a challenging contemporary environment.

Throughout 2023 the school community continued to consolidate and strengthen the faith formation of students and staff, as well as focus more deeply on the teaching and the learning, with a particular emphasis on the use of data to drive future learning.

We continued to ensure that all students under our care improved their learning outcomes with individual and differentiated programs to ensure academic success. Our focus was on building positive relationships.

Expenditure And Teacher Participation in Professional Learning	
List Professional Learning undertaken in 2023	
The Resilience Project First Aid and Anaphylaxis training Warden Training - Emergency Management NCCD Disability standards for Education for Primary Schools (NCCD Modules) Mandatory Reporting Modules School Leaders Network Days Rob Galea Encounter PL (whole staff) and online course. Stephen Nash (MACS) - Charism of The Good Shepherd. Australian Catholics Resources- whole staff PL on navigating the online portal. Mappen Inquiry PL	
Number of teachers who participated in PL in 2023	32
Average expenditure per teacher for PL	\$1000.00

Teacher Satisfaction

School climate - perceptions of the overall social and learning climate of the school 72%

Collective efficacy - teachers perceptions of staff at the school have what it takes to improve instruction. 74%

Teacher Qualifications	
Doctorate	0.0%
Masters	14.0%
Graduate	9.3%
Graduate Certificate	0.0%
Bachelor Degree	51.2%
Advanced Diploma	11.6%
No Qualifications Listed	14.0%

Staff Composition	
Principal Class (Headcount)	2
Teaching Staff (Headcount)	50
Teaching Staff (FTE)	39.3
Non-Teaching Staff (Headcount)	33
Non-Teaching Staff (FTE)	25.7
Indigenous Teaching Staff (Headcount)	0

Community Engagement

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Goal:

To develop closer relationships with families and local communities.

Intended Outcome:

That we draw on the richness of our diverse school and local community to enhance student learning and wellbeing.

Achievements

Good Shepherd continues to provide opportunities to strengthen partnerships between families, staff, our parish and the wider community.

Parishioners and staff collaborate to prepare students for Sacramental Programs. Students from all year levels strengthen their relationship to God through collection and preparation of Christmas Hampers for St Vincent de Paul. Parishioners and the school also come together to celebrate the Feast of the Good Shepherd and the end of year Carols night.

The Parents and Friends Association supports the school with fundraising events such as the Colour Run, sausage sizzles, Mother's and Father's Day Stalls. The connection between families has also been strengthened through the Parents and Friends Association's facilitation of family themed nights such as the School Disco night, an Outdoor Cinema night and the Family Rollerama night.

Students gain a sense of community through participating in Lunchtime clubs such as Sports Club, Gardening Club, Art Club and participation in the Hub. These opportunities provide students with authentic experiences to meet with peers and staff and connect around their shared interests.

Members of the wider community are invited to run clinics such as football and netball clinics with our students

Networks are strengthened between families and staff through Parent Teacher meetings, Meet and Greet nights, Grandparents Day, Whole school Sports Day and regular whole school assemblies.

Seesaw, email, newsletters and Audiri are platforms that Good shepherd employ to provide regular and timely communication to families about the school program and activities. "Round the classes" is a comprehensive communication to families which outlines the students' school learning program. This termly communication strengthens school and home connections.

Parent Satisfaction

In the area of School climate - Families' perceptions of the social and learning climate of the school. Our responses indicated that 73% felt positive about the experience at Good Shepherd.

Financial Performance

The school's financial performance information and a report of the financial activities of the school's boarding premises (if applicable) have been provided to the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission (ACNC) and will be available for the community to access from their website at www.acnc.gov.au.

For more detailed information regarding our school please visit our website at www.goodshep.vic.edu.au